

Trump nears a historic decision on Iran

U.S. could join Israel's war, as opportunity to end Tehran's nuclear program has arisen.

By MICHAEL WILNER

WASHINGTON — President Trump is nearing a historic decision on whether to join Israel's war against Iran, a choice that will reshape the Middle East while dividing his Cabinet and his party over America's role in the world.

The fateful choice has presented itself, U.S. and Israeli officials told The Times, after Israeli forces cleared a runway for Washington's involvement by hobbling Iranian air defenses and reducing the risks to U.S. aircraft. "We now have complete and total control of the skies over Iran," Trump wrote on social media Tuesday, calling for Iran's "unconditional surrender" over the future of its decades-old nuclear program.

Up until Friday, when Israel's surprise attack began, the president had been skeptical of its prospects and had distanced himself from the operation. Israel's air and intelligence forces have targeted Iran's nuclear sites, scientific and military leadership, air defenses and ballistic missile networks, killing at least 224 people, according to Iranian authorities.

Germany's chancellor, Friedrich Merz, bluntly described the Israeli operation in a Tuesday interview. "This is the dirty work that Israel is doing for all of us," he said.

[See **Mideast**, A4]



ARAB ISRAELI mourners comfort the mother of a victim of an Iranian missile attack in Tamra, Israel.

JOHN WESSELS AFP/Getty Images

7 indicted in massive jewelry theft at Grapevine truck stop

Only some of the gems taken in 2022 Brink's heist are recovered

By DANIEL MILLER,
BRITTNY MEJIA
AND RICHARD WINTON

It was a jewelry heist days in the making — one allegedly planned by thieves who had worked their way up to a major score after honing their covert craft in the parking lots and truck stops of San Bernardino County.

When they broke into a Brink's big rig at a remote Grapevine truck stop in the dead of night three years ago, the men may have gotten more than they bargained for: a haul that could be worth up to \$100 million.

That would make the theft of 24 bags containing jewelry, gems, watches and other precious items on July 11, 2022, among the biggest heists of all time.

All of this according to an indictment unsealed Tuesday by federal

[See **Brink's**, A8]



MYUNG J. CHUN Los Angeles Times

THE FLYING J Travel Center in Lebec, Calif., was the scene of the July 11, 2022, crime, considered among the biggest heists of all time.

Court weighs case for troops in L.A.

9th Circuit will decide whether Trump can deploy the military to quell protests, aid ICE.

By SONJA SHARP

The U.S. 9th Circuit Court of Appeals heard arguments Tuesday questioning both President Trump's decision to deploy federal troops to Los Angeles and the court's right to review it, teeing up what is likely to be a fierce new challenge to presidential power in the U.S. Supreme Court.

A panel of three judges — two appointed by President Trump, one by President Biden — pressed hard on the administration's central assertion that the president had nearly unlimited discretion to deploy the military on American streets.

But they also appeared to cast doubt on last week's ruling from a federal judge in San Francisco that control of the National Guard must immediately return to California authorities. A pause on that decision remains in effect while the judges deliberate, with a decision expected as soon as this week.

"The crucial question... is whether the judges seem inclined to accept Trump's argument that he alone gets to decide if the statutory requirements for nationalizing the California National Guard are met," said Erwin Chemerinsky, dean of the UC Berkeley School of Law.

The questions at the heart of the case test the limits of presidential authority, which the U.S. Supreme Court has vastly expanded in recent years.

[See **Troops**, A7]



MEL MELCON Los Angeles Times

IN CALIFORNIA, 88% of landscaping and groundskeeping workers are Latino.

Their work doesn't stop

Gardeners weigh the fear of being swept up in ICE raids across the region with the need for a paycheck

By JEANETTE MARANTOS

They're known as the "mow and blow" guys — the legion of predominately Latino gardeners driving pickup trucks and trailers bristling with lawn mowers, weed whackers and other yard-care equipment as they tend the yards of Southern California's suburban neighborhoods.

But Daniel, a gardener

who has lived undocumented in the U.S. for 20 years, doesn't think of himself that way. He does a lot more for his clients — trimming plants, fertilizing and weeding too. In fact, some of his clients have only tiny lawns, or no lawns at all these days, but they still need his services.

And he still needs to work, despite immigration raids taking place in Los Angeles, Orange and Ventura

counties; the latter is where he has run his yard-care business for 11 years.

Reflecting on his precarious position, he quieted his leaf blower and took off his sunglasses, giving only his first name for safety's sake.

"These times are really hard and everybody is afraid," he said, referring to Latinos broadly — regardless of immigration status. "It's really not normal, and

[See **Gardeners**, A14]

\$500 million in bonds will pay school sex abuse claims

L.A. district tries to lessen financial impact of settling suits over alleged misconduct.

By HOWARD BLUME

The Los Angeles school district will sell up to \$500 million in bonds to pay for past alleged sexual misconduct — loans that must be paid back over time by the school system — part of a blizzard of claims dating back as far as the 1970s that are affecting government entities, churches and private

organizations up and down the state.

L.A. Unified alone has faced about 370 sexual abuse claims, according to information released Monday.

By issuing bonds, which were approved at a June 3 school board meeting, the nation's second-largest school system stretches out repayments over 15 years, diluting the toll on its annual budget — and on services and programs.

Officials said Monday that L.A. Unified would initially sell \$303.6 million in bonds — because that is the amount needed to retire relatively low-cost, but

short-term, loans that the district had been using for payouts, which have totaled a staggering \$302 million in the current fiscal year alone.

Although Supt. Alberto Carvalho now has the authority to go up to \$500 million in bonds, "estimates indicate that additional amounts over \$500 million may be required," according to a district spokesperson. The bonds being used are called judgment obligation bonds.

Unlike traditional school construction and modernization bonds, voter approval is not needed for these

[See **LAUSD**, A7]

Yosemite to open all campgrounds

It's a first since 2019, and 500 more sites will be available to summer visitors than in recent years. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Ohtani shows a different side

The Dodgers slugger is playful at the plate but serious on the mound, Dylan Hernández writes. **SPORTS, B10**

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KYUSUNG GONG Associated Press
SHOHEI OHTANI said he was nervous before his return to pitching.

Mexican markets support migrants

Food businesses in the Los Angeles region speak out for their communities and keep their doors open. **BUSINESS, A9**

Weather

Sunny and very warm. L.A. Basin: 88/62. **B6**

Markets **A11**
Opinion Voices **A12**



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